



prove he owned half of what was attributed to him in a bulky volume, that carried a caricature of his on the cover showing his rise from a street vendor to someone owning property worth crores. The document lists many illegal land deals registered in the names of his family members and relatives, and it surfaced after he made dubious accusations in public against Raje loyalist PWD Minister



Rajendra Rathore.

Now yet another trend is emerging—of levelling charges against rivals of having illicit relations and hiring prostitutes. Lately, one MP has been accused of having illicit relations with a woman that, the anonymous dossier alleges, has resulted in two abortions. “This is a very disgusting trend,” says Rathore, who once faced the accusation of having relations with a prostitute, which turned out to be false. Though Raje loyalists are often targeted with rumours that extend from making huge investments in Dubai and favouring family members in land deals, dissidents are now being tackled with the same tactics. Lalit Kishore Chaturvedi, MP and former BJP state president who leads the

“The corrupt are justifying themselves by projecting everyone else as corrupt.”

LALIT K. CHATURVEDI,
FORMER STATE BJP PRESIDENT

“The Income Tax Department can investigate the charges against me.”

MADAN DILAWAR,
SOCIAL WELFARE MINISTER

“All these years, I have always tried to live a clean and transparent life.”

GULAB C. KATARIA,
STATE HOME MINISTER

dissidents, figures in a list of 400 VIPs compiled alphabetically who have had mines allotted to themselves or their kin over the past two decades. Chaturvedi's son is listed as the beneficiary in three allotments. “Perhaps once upon a time he was into this, but he no longer owns any mine to my knowledge,” says Chaturvedi. Another prominent name in the list is that of Prahalad Gunjal, BJP MLA who was expelled from the party for abusing Raje during the Gujar agitation. The dossier accuses him of making crores in illegal transactions. He, of course, denies all the charges.



The problem is that in Rajasthan almost every politician has skeletons in his or her cupboard that can be resurrected at any time. One example is Home Minister Gulab Chand Kataria. Recently, Kataria blasted Raje loyalists for asking him to recommend the allotment of land for a school in Udaipur. However, he conveniently forgot that some years ago, he had made similar recommendations for that very school. Kataria now faces further embarrassment over a land purchase case, a charge that is a year old but has been revived to keep his dissidence in check.

Predictably, the battle has given the Congress enough incentive to join the fray. Last week, former chief minister Ashok Gehlot declared that he would inquire into the business dealings of Lalit Modi as president of the Rajasthan Cricket Association. Modi is known to be close to Raje. Gehlot may find it a convenient distraction from his own problems with rival Congress leaders but he would do well to learn the lesson from Rajasthan's dirty war—that in a bathtub, everyone stands naked.

CHARGESHEET

JASWANT SINGH

Veteran BJP leader

ACCUSED OF Evading stamp duty and acquiring land illegally at several places in Jodhpur

GHANSHYAM TIWARI

Minister for Education

ACCUSED OF Forging benami partnerships in dozens of restaurants

GULAB CHAND KATARIA

State Home Minister

ACCUSED OF Using position to avoid registration charges in land purchase

LALIT KISHORE CHATURVEDI

Former state BJP president

ACCUSED OF Illegally allotting mines to himself and his relatives

MADAN DILAWAR

Social Welfare Minister

ACCUSED OF Registering land deals in the name of family members